Global Marketing by Confectionery Businesses

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What is global marketing?

- Global marketing refers to how businesses **sell their products in multiple countries**, adapting or standardising their marketing mix to suit different markets
  - Confectionery and biscuit businesses often operate internationally because growth in individual countries, such as the UK, is limited
- Businesses must decide whether to:
  - use a **standardised approach**, keeping products and marketing similar worldwide
  - use an **adapted approach**, changing products and strategies for local markets
  - or use a **mixed approach**, combining global brands with local adaptation

Product strategies

- Many confectionery and biscuit businesses sell **global brands**, but adapt their products to suit **local tastes, cultures and consumption habits**
  - This allows firms to benefit from strong global brand recognition while still appealing to consumers in different countries
- A common approach is to keep the **core product and brand identity the same**, while making selective adaptations to improve local appeal

How products are adapted for different markets

- Global businesses often keep:
  - the same brand name and logo
  - the same basic product format, such as a chocolate bar or biscuit
- However, they may adapt specific features, including:
  - **flavours**, to reflect local preferences
  - **sweetness levels**, as tastes vary between regions

Stuck on something?
Ask questions and get help with exactly what you're revising.
Got it

expectations

Examples

- KitKat flavours vary by country, with unique flavours in Japan that reflect local tastes
- Oreo uses the same core biscuit worldwide, but adapts flavours and fillings for different markets

Different flavours of well-known brands target global markets

- This allows firms to benefit from **brand recognition** while appealing to local consumers.

Pricing strategies

- Pricing in global confectionery and biscuit markets **varies significantly between countries**
  - Businesses respond to local economic and competitive conditions rather than charge a single global price
  - Prices differ because of:
    - **Income levels**, as consumers in higher-income countries can afford higher-priced branded treats
    - **Exchange rates**, which affect the cost of importing ingredients and finished products
    - **Taxes**, including **import duties**, which increase prices in some markets
    - **Local competition**, including strong domestic brands and own-label products

Strategies in different markets

Type of market	Examples	Explanation

Developed markets	• The UK, Western Europe and North America	• Many confectionery and biscuit businesses use **premium** pricing
		• Consumers in these markets are often willing to pay more for:
		  ○ trusted brands
		  ○ premium ingredients
		  ○ ethical or sustainable

		significantly higher in the UK and Western Europe ○ Chocolate is often bought as a gift and consumers accept higher prices for perceived quality
Emerging markets	• South America, Africa and the Middle East	• Global firms are more likely to use **penetration** or **value pricing** to increase sales volumes and build market share • This is often achieved through: ○ **smaller pack sizes**, which lower the upfront price ○ simpler packaging ○ fewer premium features • E.g. **Mars and Snickers** are sold in smaller single-bar formats in lower-income markets to keep prices affordable • **Oreo** is often sold in small, low-priced packs in emerging markets to encourage trial and repeat purchase

- By varying prices and pack sizes:
  - businesses can **maximise revenue** in high-income markets
  - remain **competitive** and **accessible** in lower-income markets
  - avoid pricing themselves out of local markets

Help me understand

Distribution (place) strategies

- Confectionery and biscuits are **fast-moving consumer goods** that rely on wide availability and frequent purchase
  - A product is unlikely to succeed internationally if it is not **easy for consumers to find and buy**
- Businesses must decide:

stores or online
    - how to manage international supply chains, including transport, storage and reliability

Strategies in different markets

Type of market	Examples	Explanation

Developed markets	• The UK, Western Europe and North America	• Confectionery and biscuits are sold mainly through **large supermarket chains and national convenience retailers**
		  ○ Brands such as **Cadbury, Mars and Oreo** are stocked by Tesco, Sainsbury's, Asda and Morrisons
		  ○ Convenience formats like **Tesco Express and Sainsbury's Local** are important for impulse confectionery
		  ○ Online grocery platforms, including supermarket websites, play a growing role
		• In these markets, strong relationships with major retailers are essential. Large multinationals benefit because they can:
		  ○ guarantee high and reliable supply volumes
		  ○ fund promotions and in-store displays
		  ○ negotiate favourable shelf positions

Emerging markets	• South America, Africa and the Middle East	• Retail structures are often more fragmented, so global firms adapt their distribution strategies • Instead of relying mainly on supermarkets, businesses often sell through

		retailers - local wholesalers and distributors - Global brands such as **Mars and Nestlé** use extensive local distribution networks to reach small retailers - Products are often sold in **single units or small packs** to suit local shopping habits - This approach helps brands reach a much wider customer base in countries where large supermarkets are less common

Promotion strategies

- Promotion is often the **most visible part** of global marketing, but it is closely linked to the other elements of the marketing mix.
- Approaches include:
  - Global advertising campaigns using the same brand message
  - Localised campaigns that reflect culture, language and values

Standardised global promotion

- Many global confectionery and biscuit brands use **standardised advertising campaigns** that communicate the same core message worldwide
  - It reinforces a **strong global brand identity**
  - It reduces marketing costs
  - Businesses can ensure consistent messaging across markets

Examples

- Brands such as **Mars, Snickers** and **Oreo** use similar logos, packaging and slogans in many countries
- Oreo's playful tone and visual identity are recognisable worldwide

Localised promotion

- Other businesses adapt promotion to reflect **local culture, language** and **values**
  - This seen when
    - advertising uses local languages and humour
    - campaigns link to national festivals or traditions
    - products are promoted differently depending on how they are consumed locally

Easter or Valentine's Day in different countries
- Promotional messages vary to reflect gifting traditions or family-focused occasions

An example of locally-adapted promotional activity

The role of social media and digital promotion

- Social media has transformed global promotion by making it easier to run **global campaigns with local targeting**
- Businesses can
  - use the same campaign idea worldwide
  - tailor content to specific countries or age groups
  - respond quickly to local trends

Examples

- Confectionery brands use **TikTok and Instagram** to launch limited editions aimed at younger consumers
  - E.g. Mondelēz launched Oreo biscuits featuring Pokémon characters by promoting them heavily with short videos and challenges on **TikTok and Instagram**

Approaches to global marketing

Case Study

Mars – largely standardised global marketing

- Mars, one of the world's largest confectionery businesses, uses a largely **standardised global marketing strategy**, especially for its core chocolate brands

Product	Price
• Products such as **Mars, Snickers and Twix** are sold worldwide with very similar recipes • Packaging and branding are consistent across countries • This creates strong global brand recognition	• Prices vary by country due to income levels and taxes • However, Mars positions its brands as **mainstream, affordable treats** in most markets
Place	**Promotion**

• Mars sells through:
  ○ major supermarkets
  ○ convenience stores
  ○ petrol stations
• Its global scale allows it to secure shelf space in almost every market it enters
	• Uses globally recognisable slogans and branding
	• Advertising often focuses on universal themes such as hunger, energy or sharing

Advantages of Mars' approach

- Mars's global marketing approach helps it to benefit from **economies of scale**
  - Producing the same products in large volumes across many countries helps to reduce average production costs
  - This allows Mars to price its products competitively while maintaining profit margins
- The company also benefits from **strong global brand consistency**, with familiar branding and messaging
  - These reinforce recognition and trust in different markets

Disadvantages of Mars' approach

- This largely standardised approach may make Mars **less responsive to local tastes and cultural differences**
  - Competitors that adapt flavours, formats or marketing more closely to local preferences may be better placed to meet consumer needs

Case Study

Ferrero – adapted and premium global marketing

- Ferrero uses an **adapted global marketing strategy**, focusing on **premium positioning** and tailoring products to specific occasions and cultures

Product	Price
• Kinder products are aimed at families and children • Ferrero Rocher is positioned as a **premium gifting chocolate**, especially at Christmas • Product focus varies by market and occasion	• Ferrero uses **premium pricing** in many markets • Higher prices support a quality and gifting image
Place	**Promotion**

• Products are widely available in supermarkets
• Special attention is given to **seasonal displays and gifting sections**
	• Advertising often highlights:
	  ○ quality
	  ○ family values
	  ○ gifting and celebration
	• Campaigns are adapted to suit local traditions and festivals

Advantages of Ferrero's approach

- Ferrero's premium global marketing strategy clearly **differentiates its brands from mass-market competitors**
  - This is especially improtant for its gifting and quality positioning
  - It allows Ferrero to **avoid direct price competition** and **achieve higher profit margins**, particularly in higher-income markets

Disadvantages of Ferrero's approach

- Premium pricing **limits Ferrero's appeal in price-sensitive markets**
- This makes it more vulnerable during economic downturns, when consumers are more likely to switch to

Case Study

Oreo's mixed approach to global biscuit marketing

- Oreo uses a **mixed global marketing strategy**, combining a highly standardised global brand with **local adaptation** to suit different markets, cultures and income levels

Product	Price

• Oreo's **core product is standardised worldwide**, which helps build strong global brand recognition.
  ○ Two chocolate biscuits with a cream filling
  ○ Instantly recognisable design and branding
 	
However, Mondelēz adapts Oreo products to suit **local tastes and consumption habits**.
  ○ Different flavours in different countries, such as green tea in parts of Asia or peanut butter in North America
  ○ Limited-edition flavours linked to local food trends
  ○ Adjustments to sweetness levels and portion sizes
	• Oreo is positioned as a **mainstream, affordable branded biscuit**, rather than a premium product.
	• Prices vary between countries due to differences in income levels, competition, taxes and exchange rates
	  ○ In higher-income markets such as the UK, Oreo is priced as an affordable branded treat
	  ○ In lower-income markets, Oreo is often sold in smaller packs or single units at lower price points

Place	**Promotion**
• Oreo benefits from **very wide global distribution**, supported by Mondelēz's international supply chains.	• Promotion is a **key strength** of Oreo's global marketing strategy ○ Uses playful, humorous

and online grocery platforms
  - In emerging markets, Oreo is also widely available through small local retailers
- Strong distribution networks allow Oreo to achieve high availability and compete effectively with both global and local brands.
	consumers
	  - Maintains a strong presence on social media platforms such as TikTok and Instagram
	  - A well-known global campaign is **"Twist, Lick, Dunk"**, which uses a simple, universal message that works across cultures
	- At the same time, Oreo adapts promotion to:
	  - local languages
	  - local social media platforms
	  - cultural events and trends

Advantages of Oreo's approach

- Oreo's global marketing strategy benefits from **strong brand recognition and consistency**, which supports rapid international expansion
- At the same time, flexible product adaptation allows Oreo to respond to local tastes, helping it compete effectively in diverse markets
- Its mainstream pricing and wide distribution also support **high sales volumes**

Disadvantages of Oreo's approach

- However, Oreo faces **intense competition** from supermarket own-label biscuits and established local brands, particularly in price-sensitive markets
- The brand also relies heavily on frequent promotions and innovation, which can **increase costs and pressure profit margins**

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